

Steven Wilssens

Product leader · Data, experimentation, and AI

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SUMMARY

Product and technology leader with more than a decade at Microsoft, most recently Principal Group Product Manager for Windows + Devices Data. Led the product team behind the data platform, experimentation, and machine-learning insights that informed product decisions across more than a billion Windows devices. Earlier, led the Microsoft Spatial Audio Platform across Windows and Xbox (seven granted US patents) and defined new products for Azure DevOps. Began as a software developer and team lead in Belgium, and still builds hands-on, including AI tools for internal teams. Now exploring product leadership roles in data, experimentation, audio, and AI.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Increased Windows adoption by 15% through data-driven product improvements and strategic initiatives.
- Improved user retention by 20% through enhanced adoption strategies and engagement programs.
- Reduced customer issues by 30% through telemetry integration and analysis.
- Increased product quality by 25% by applying AI and ML in development processes.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Group Product Manager, Windows + Devices Data

Dec 2024 – Sep 2026

Microsoft · Redmond, WA

Led the PM team responsible for the data, insights, experimentation, and ML models that power decision-making across Windows and Devices.

- Owned strategy and roadmap for the data platform and insights products that Windows engineers and PMs used to ship higher-quality releases.
- Led product managers driving experimentation, customer-signal analysis, and ML-powered insight products.
- Partnered with engineering, data science, and research leadership to turn telemetry from more than a billion Windows devices into decisions on adoption, retention, quality, and engagement.
- Set the vision for how AI and ML are used internally to accelerate Windows product development.

Principal Product Manager Lead, CSX Data

Feb 2020 – Dec 2024

Microsoft · Redmond, WA

Led the team that used big data to tell the story of the Windows customer experience and inform its continuous improvement.

- Combined customer signals and machine learning into insights for Microsoft engineers.
- Enabled data-supported decisions to release higher-quality hardware, software, and services.
- Helped teams quickly detect and address real issues affecting customers' experiences.

Principal Product Manager Lead, Azure DevOps

Sep 2019 – Feb 2020

Microsoft · Redmond, WA

- Increased market penetration by defining new products, go-to-market strategies, and business decisions for the Azure DevOps Platform.
- Spearheaded rapid business and product analysis for a new product that became a core priority for GitHub following its \$7B+ acquisition.

Principal Product Manager Lead, Silicon, Graphics & Media

Jan 2018 – Sep 2019

Microsoft · Operating Systems Group · Redmond, WA

Led audio, spatial audio, game streaming, xCloud, Game DVR & broadcast, and casting.

- Led the Microsoft Spatial Audio Platform, working with developers and data insights to deliver essential spatial audio features on Windows, Xbox One, and new platforms.
- Grew monthly active devices playing spatial audio by more than 250% over 1.5 years, reaching millions of users across OEM devices, Xbox consoles, and consumer acquisitions.

Principal Product Manager, Silicon, Graphics & Media

Sep 2017 - Jan 2018

Microsoft · Operating Systems Group · Redmond, WA

Drove the Windows Sonic spatial audio platform for Windows and Xbox One; spoke at major game and developer conferences.

- Drove the launch of Dolby Access v3 and DTS Sound Unbound with new app services, licensing, and customization models on PC and Xbox.
- Established partnerships with Surface, Store, Marketing, and Gaming to bring spatial audio to more endpoints and games.
- Collaborated with Disney+ and Netflix to bring Dolby Atmos to Xbox and Windows.

Senior Product Manager, Silicon, Graphics & Media

Oct 2008 - Aug 2017

Microsoft · Operating Systems Group · Redmond, WA

- Developed the Spatial Audio Platform, including Windows Sonic, for Windows and Xbox One.
- Shipped platform technology spanning audio, media, and connected entertainment experiences.
- Built the technical and partner foundation for a portfolio of spatial audio patents.

Lead Developer and Team Lead

Jan 2005 - Dec 2006

Compuware · Belgium

- Hired, evaluated, trained, and assigned work for a team of about 15 developers.
- Led the Project Support Office at Fluxys: implemented a new development process and framework, coached developers and architects, and managed the build team and infrastructure.
- Spoke at Microsoft Belgium Developer & IT Pro Days on application development and advanced source control, and presented Visual Studio Team System to customers for Microsoft Belgium.

Software Developer

Jan 2004 - Dec 2005

Cosmos · Antwerp area, Belgium

- Built and supported core software components in C# (client) and Java (server) using CORBA middleware.
- Provided technical guidance and education as a member of the Cosmos Institute; redesigned existing applications and led code reviews.

Developer and Trainer

Jan 2001 - Dec 2004

Info Support · Belgium

- Led a development team at Agfa Gevaert and built .NET Windows and web applications in C# for Agfa Gevaert, Cosmos, De Post, Petrobel, and Info Support.
- Built scalable distributed applications with ADO.NET and SQL Server, and advised project and management teams on .NET architecture.

PATENTS

Spatializing audio data based on analysis of incoming audio data	US 11,595,774
Frame coding for spatial audio data	US 10,535,355
Personalization of spatial audio for streaming platforms	US 10,469,975
Shared three-dimensional audio bed	US 10,419,866
Adaptive audio rendering	US 10,325,610
Game streaming with spatial audio	US 10,123,150
Spatial audio resource management using minimum resource working sets	US 10,056,086

AWARDS

Microsoft Lighthouse Award for Teamwork	2012
Microsoft Compass Award for Individual Excellence	2011
Microsoft Gold Star Award	2011
Most Valuable Professional (MVP): VS Team System	2006

EDUCATION

Bachelor's degree, Computer Science · Karel de Grote, Belgium	2000 - 2004
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LANGUAGES

Dutch and English (native), French (intermediate)

SKILLS

Product strategy and roadmaps · Data platforms and telemetry · Experimentation · ML and AI products · People leadership and PM team building · Stakeholder and budget management · Partnerships · Streaming media and audio technologies · Software development (C#, .NET) · Agile delivery